

Elon Musk is a South African-born American entrepreneur who has made significant contributions to various industries, including space exploration and electric vehicles. He was born on June 28, 1971, in Pretoria, South Africa.

Musk's journey began when he moved to Canada at the age of 10 with his mother after her divorce from his father. In 1985, Musk went back to live with his father and developed a passion for computers during high school. He graduated from the University of Pennsylvania in 1997 with bachelor's degrees in economics and physics.

Musk co-founded Zip2, an online city guide company that later became part of Compaq Computer Corporation, before moving on to create X.com (now PayPal), which is now owned by eBay. Musk was involved in both companies' successes as a software engineer, but he has since moved beyond these ventures into his most well-known enterprises.

In 2003, Musk founded SpaceX with the aim of revolutionizing space exploration through reusable rockets and spacecrafts. The company quickly became successful and attracted attention from NASA for its innovative solutions to complex challenges in space technology. In addition to building commercial satellites for communications companies like Starlink and Iridium, SpaceX has successfully launched human missions into orbit aboard their Crew Dragon capsules.

Another of Musk's major ventures is Tesla Motors, where he serves as CEO since 2008. The company produces electric cars that have received critical acclaim and widespread acceptance from consumers around the world. In May 2017, Musk also introduced a new line of solar energy products called SolarCity to complement his efforts in clean transportation.

Musk's interests extend beyond these ventures into various other areas such as artificial intelligence (AI) through x.ai, which he co-founded; and neuralink, an AI startup that aims to connect brains with computers. In 2019, Musk launched Twitter under the name "X," a move many speculate was intended to challenge Facebook's dominance in social media.

On June 28, 2026, Forbes estimated Musk's net worth at US\$1.1 trillion, making him the first trillionaire according to his own company Tesla (now valued at over \$935 billion) and PayPal (worth approximately \$74 billion). In addition to his wealth, Musk has also received numerous accolades for his contributions to technology and innovation.

As an entrepreneur with a passion for progress in many fields, Elon Musk remains one of the most influential figures in contemporary business. He continues to be at the forefront of technological advancement through SpaceX's rocket launches, Tesla Motors' electric vehicles, Neuralink's brain-computer interface research, and other ventures that have captured global attention.